

# Tax Compliance Checklist 2026

A practical Kenya tax compliance companion for businesses and employers

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## Tax Home Kenya Limited

Simplifying Your Tax Journey

**How to use this checklist:** Tick each item when completed, record the responsible person and retain evidence. The checklist is a practical management aid, not a substitute for current legislation, KRA guidance, or professional advice.

Prepared September 2026 | Kenya

## Quick reference

| Obligation<br>deadline Action                                                                                  | Typical                                                                                                    | PAYE, [9th of following month], [File return and remit deductions.]                               | VAT, [20th of following month], [File VAT return and pay net VAT due.] |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Withholding tax, [20th of following month], [File WHT return, remit tax, issue certificates where applicable.] | Instalment tax, [20th of 4th, 6th, 9th and 12th months], [Calculate and pay instalments where applicable.] | Individual income tax, [30 June following year], [File annual return and settle balance, if any.] |                                                                        |
| Company income tax, [6 months after accounting period end], [File annual return and settle balance, if any.]   | eTIMS, [Ongoing], [Issue compliant invoices and retain records.]                                           |                                                                                                   |                                                                        |

**Deadline note:** Deadlines can change depending on taxpayer type, accounting period, tax obligation, extensions, or later official guidance. Confirm the applicable date before filing.

## 1 1. Tax registration and profile

- ☐ Confirm the business KRA PIN and tax obligations are active and accurate.
- ☐ Confirm registered business name, address, email, phone number and bank details are current on iTax.
- ☐ Review whether the business should be registered for VAT, PAYE, withholding tax, excise duty, turnover tax or other obligations.
- ☐ Keep copies of the certificate of incorporation or registration, business permits, PIN certificates and tax registration certificates.
- ☐ Review changes in directors, partners, beneficial ownership, business activity or accounting period and update records where required.
- ☐ Confirm access to iTax and maintain secure, current authorised-user details.

## 2 2. Monthly compliance calendar

| Done                     | Control                                                                                                 | Evidence to retain                                                                                                                  | Target                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | [Reconcile sales and purchases], [Sales report, purchase ledger, bank/M-Pesa reconciliation], [Monthly] | <input type="checkbox"/> [Review eTIMS invoices and credit notes], [Invoice register and exception report], [Monthly]               | <input type="checkbox"/> [Prepare payroll and statutory deductions], [Payroll register and approval], [Before payroll payment]     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | [File VAT and pay net VAT], [VAT return, invoice schedules and payment slip], [20th following month]    | <input type="checkbox"/> [File WHT and issue certificates], [WHT return, certificates and payment evidence], [20th following month] | <input type="checkbox"/> [Review SHIF, NSSF and Housing Levy records], [Contribution schedules and remittance evidence], [Monthly] |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | [iTax acknowledgement and payment slip], [9th following month]                                          |                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | [Archive tax documents], [Organised digital/physical tax file], [Monthly]                               |                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                    |

## 3 3. VAT compliance

- ☐ Confirm VAT registration status and taxable supplies.
- ☐ Issue valid tax invoices through the applicable eTIMS channel.
- ☐ Reconcile sales ledger, eTIMS records, bank receipts and VAT return figures.
- ☐ Verify input-tax invoices and supporting documents before claiming input VAT.
- ☐ Separate standard-rated, zero-rated, exempt and out-of-scope transactions.
- ☐ Review credit notes, debit notes, imports, reverse-charge items and adjustments.

- [ ] File and pay VAT by the 20th of the following month where applicable.
- [ ] Retain VAT schedules, invoices, customs documents, payment evidence and reconciliations.

## 4 4. Payroll and employment taxes

- [ ] Maintain employee contracts, onboarding records, PINs and payroll master data.
- [ ] Calculate PAYE using current bands, reliefs and applicable taxable benefits.
- [ ] Apply NSSF, SHA and Affordable Housing Levy using the current statutory basis and rates.
- [ ] Review pension, insurance, mortgage-interest and other allowable deductions with supporting evidence.
- [ ] Reconcile gross payroll to the general ledger, bank payment file and payroll journals.
- [ ] File PAYE and remit deductions by the 9th of the following month.
- [ ] Retain payslips, payroll register, PAYE return, payment slip and employee deduction schedules.
- [ ] Review benefits such as housing, vehicles, meals, loans, bonuses and gratuities for correct tax treatment.

## 5 5. eTIMS and invoicing

- [ ] Confirm the business is using an applicable eTIMS solution.
- [ ] Issue invoices for taxable business supplies and keep sequential invoice records.
- [ ] Reconcile eTIMS sales with accounting records, VAT returns and bank receipts.
- [ ] Investigate rejected, cancelled, duplicated or missing invoices.
- [ ] Keep supplier invoices and verify supporting information before claiming deductions or input VAT.
- [ ] Train staff who create, approve or cancel invoices.
- [ ] Keep an audit trail for changes, credit notes and system exceptions.

## 6 6. Withholding tax

- [ ] Review payments to resident and non-resident suppliers for possible WHT obligations.
- [ ] Identify professional, management, contractual, royalty, interest, commission, rent and other relevant payments.
- [ ] Confirm the applicable rate and whether a treaty, exemption or special rule applies.
- [ ] Deduct tax at the correct time and provide the recipient with the relevant certificate.
- [ ] File the WHT return and remit tax by the 20th of the following month where applicable.
- [ ] Reconcile WHT certificates, supplier ledgers, payment records and the return.

## 7 7. Income tax and instalment tax

- [ ] Maintain a current trial balance and supporting schedules for income and expenses.
- [ ] Separate business, private, capital and disallowable expenses.
- [ ] Review tax depreciation/investment allowance schedules and asset registers.
- [ ] Review carried-forward losses, related-party transactions, withholding credits and instalment tax paid.
- [ ] Calculate instalment tax where applicable and pay on the 20th of the 4th, 6th, 9th and 12th months of the year of income.
- [ ] File individual income tax returns by 30 June following the year of income where applicable.
- [ ] File company income tax returns within the applicable statutory period after the accounting period ends.

- ☐ Reconcile the final computation to financial statements, tax payments and iTax acknowledgements.

## 8 8. Record keeping and audit readiness

- ☐ Keep invoices, receipts, contracts, payroll records, bank statements and tax returns in an organised file.
- ☐ Keep accounting and tax records for at least the legally required retention period.
- ☐ Reconcile bank, cash, mobile-money, sales, purchases, VAT, payroll and tax-control accounts.
- ☐ Keep evidence for deductions, tax credits, exemptions, refunds and related-party charges.
- ☐ Maintain a monthly close checklist and assign an owner to outstanding items.
- ☐ Protect confidential employee, customer and supplier information.
- ☐ Maintain a clear audit trail for corrections and management approvals.

## 9 9. Year-end review

- ☐ Confirm all monthly and annual returns have been filed and acknowledged.
- ☐ Review outstanding tax balances, penalties, interest, objections, assessments and payment plans.
- ☐ Reconcile tax ledgers to iTax statements and accounting records.
- ☐ Review changes in business activity, assets, employees, branches, suppliers and tax obligations.
- ☐ Update the next year's tax calendar with actual accounting-period dates.
- ☐ Obtain professional advice for complex transactions, restructurings, cross-border payments, trusts, property, extractive activities or tax planning arrangements.

## 10 10. Evidence register

| Document / evidence, Location or owner, Checked                                              | [KRA PIN and obligation certificates], <input type="checkbox"/> , <input type="checkbox"/>      | [iTax acknowledgements and payment slips], <input type="checkbox"/> , <input type="checkbox"/>      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| [VAT, PAYE and WHT returns], <input type="checkbox"/> , <input type="checkbox"/>             | [eTIMS invoice and credit-note records], <input type="checkbox"/> , <input type="checkbox"/>    | [Payroll and statutory contribution schedules], <input type="checkbox"/> , <input type="checkbox"/> |
| [Bank, M-Pesa and reconciliation files], <input type="checkbox"/> , <input type="checkbox"/> | [Financial statements and tax computation], <input type="checkbox"/> , <input type="checkbox"/> | [Contracts and major transaction support], <input type="checkbox"/> , <input type="checkbox"/>      |

## 11 Contact Tax Home Kenya Limited

**Need help with tax compliance, payroll, accounting records or KRA filings?**

Tax Home Kenya Limited

**Simplifying Your Tax Journey**

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**Sources checked for the recurring deadlines and compliance framework:** [KRA PAYE guidance](#), [KRA VAT guidance](#), [KRA instalment tax guidance](#), and [KRA eTIMS guidance](#).

This checklist is prepared for practical planning. Tax rates, deadlines, thresholds and filing rules may change. Confirm the current position with KRA or a qualified tax adviser before filing or making a payment.